Cyberbullying

Online Harassment Terms

Cyberbullying — bullying online with phones or computers: hurtful messages, fake photos or lies.

Cancel culture — shaming someone in public online and cutting them off for what they did.

Cyberstalking — repeatedly sending threatening messages to frighten someone and invade their privacy.

Doxing — finding and posting someone's private details, like their address, for others to see.

Exclusion — leaving one person out of a group chat or an event on purpose.

Flaming — sending angry, insulting messages online; the back-and-forth becomes a "flame war".

Ghosting — cutting off all contact with someone and disappearing, often to end a friendship.

Harassment — repeatedly sending rude or abusive messages, in public or in private.

Revenge porn — posting private sexual images of a former partner without their consent.

Sextortion — threatening to share a private image unless the person does what you want.

Trolling — posting upsetting comments on purpose to start a fight or get a reaction.

Griefing — ruining other players' game on purpose in an online multiplayer game.

Vocabulary

troll — noun, someone who posts to anger others

threaten — verb, to say you will hurt someone

speak out — phrasal verb, to say openly what you think is wrong

hurtful — adjective, causing pain or sadness

offensive — adjective, rude and insulting

hate speech — noun, cruel words aimed at a whole group

abusive — adjective, very cruel and harmful

bully — verb, to frighten or hurt someone weaker

Discussion

What is cyberbullying, and how is it different from old-fashioned bullying?

Have you or someone you know been bullied online? What happened?

How can being bullied online affect a young person's mental health?

Can you think of a recent case of cyberbullying you saw online?

Should cyberbullying be a crime? Why or why not?

Does being anonymous online make people crueler than they are in person?

What can schools and parents do to stop cyberbullying?

Should apps like WeChat or Douyin be responsible for what users post?

If your friend were being trolled, what would you tell them to do?

Have you ever seen a "keyboard warrior" attack someone in the comments?

Should parents be held responsible for what their children do online?

Why do some people join in when they see someone being piled on?

Is it ever right to shame someone publicly for something they said?

What should you do if a private photo of you were shared without your consent?

How can you tell the difference between a joke and real harassment?

What would make the internet a kinder place for young people?